

Here's a Slowlane story pulled from the pages of the Fastlane Forum (TheFastlaneForum.com):

In the quest for becoming wealthy, my life has become quite uncomfortable. It all started five years ago when I had nothing. I had turned 30 years old and I thought that living paycheck to paycheck was no way to live at all. I made a vow to myself that I would become wealthy. In order to do this I took on a second job and saved all of the money from that job while I used the money from the first job to pay for my living expenses. Basically, the last five years of my life have been as such in order for me to save money:

- living and paying relatively cheap rent for an 8×13 foot room
- using public transportation and a motorcycle for transportation.
- working almost every day with no days off during the week
- rarely eating out
- never buying “toys” or nice things for myself or wife
- almost never going out and having a good time

With the second job and my economical lifestyle I have managed to save about \$50,000 in five years. It would have been more, but I lost a good \$30,000 when I invested right before the Dow hit its peak in October of 2007.

I've reached a breaking point. Five years is a long time to live in a room no bigger than a jail cell. The jobs are mind numbing. I feel like my life is a prison. I have a good lifestyle for saving money, but at the expense of my mental sanity and happiness as a human being. I just feel like I can't live like this any longer.

The Slowlaner accepts an existence of frugality and sacrifice to a tipping-point where life feels like incarceration. Does this guy's life seem awesome or mediocre? Will it merge with a dream? The Slowlane plan forsakes *the now* for a faint promise of a wealthy future. I don't consider “settle for less” a strategy, which is why the Slowlane is predisposed to mediocrity. Life isn't great, but it isn't so bad either. No, it could be better . . . but you've got to swap the Slowlane for a new plan.

CHAPTER SUMMARY: FASTLANE DISTINCTIONS

- The Slowlane is a natural course-correction from the Sidewalk evolving from taking responsibility and accountability.
- Wealth is best experienced when you're young, vibrant, and able, not in the twilight of your life.
- The Slowlane is a plan that takes decades to succeed, often requiring masterful political prowess in a corporate environment.